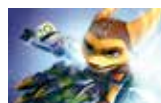


All isn't well with PCs

Analysts say that with the increasing tablet philia the use of laptops has gone down
<http://dgit.in/17v0MZs>



R & C Movie

A Ratchet and Clank movie will be out by 2015. Fingers crossed in the hope that it doesn't suck
<http://dgit.in/17WbwQX>

HOW WE TESTED

The goal of our test this time was to determine which camera would give the best image quality not only at varying ISOs, but also at varying apertures. In DSLR lenses, the common notion is that a lens isn't delivering optimum sharpness at the widest aperture and therefore, requires the lens to be stopped down by almost a stop to get to that sweet spot of ultimate sharpness. We wanted to see whether the same would apply to the lenses of mirrorless cameras as well. As a camera that's going to go everywhere with you, we also wanted to make sure the video features on these shooters was up to the task of documenting all your precious moments.

We divided our tests into three parts: two for stills and one for video. One set of tests involved shooting a simulated test target in controlled light to measure color depth/accuracy, white balance accuracy and lens sharpness in the corners and center. It also helps determine the ISO performance of a camera. We also devised our test target to measure dynamic range by including



Test image used for studio shots

pure black, pure white and neutral grey areas which would effectively measure the sensor's ability to capture various levels of illumination. All test target shots were taken in Aperture Priority mode with the Aperture set to f/8 to ensure optimum depth of field.

The second phase of the test involved getting outside the studio and shooting with each of the cameras in a real world scenario. We included several kinds of still life, lots of landscape, some

macro along with the usual people shots. For our low light testing, we resorted to taking a lot of street shots at generally high ISO and wide apertures. For this, we replaced the kit lenses with a fast aperture prime lens to make sure we were able to capture the shots we needed without worrying about slow apertures, which makes shooting at night quite difficult. This was also done to check whether the lens line-up in a particular mirrorless camera system was of good quality.

Video performance was tested both, indoors and outdoors and

while the outdoor filming allowed us to gauge the dynamic range and audio prowess of each of the cameras, the indoor tests allowed us to have a true measure of how well the sensor can curtail and snub noise. We also tested how well the cameras could maintain and track focus using some very energetic children.

All cameras were tested using a 6GB Sandisk Extreme Pro SDXC UHS-I card to ensure no write speed delays in Burst mode test.

stand out are things like a better ISO range, a higher number of white balance presents, better bracketing capabilities etc. This is where the Olympus cameras outshone the competition, with the OM-D E-M5 offering the most of everything. We have upto seven bracketed frames in 1/3 EV steps and three bracketed frames in 2 or 6 steps for white balance in either of the color directions. This little guy also comes with 12 built-in white balance presets, eliminating the need to custom white balance in most situations.

BUILD AND ERGONOMICS

This section has always been quite a controversial one, given how subjective ergonomics can be. So, for our peace of mind,

we had three different people handle each camera; a child, a woman with agreeably small hands and one large burly gentleman with hands as big as an Xbox 360 controller. Then, of course, this reviewer also spent

a considerable amount of time playing with each camera.

When we look at the build quality of a camera, we want to make sure that the camera doesn't feel flimsy or like it's made of cheap plastic. Thank-

fully, none of the cameras in our shootout felt like they'd been made from leftovers. In fact, the Fujifilm X-E1 and X-Pro1 felt like solid hunks of metal that can at any given time double up as a weapon of self-defense. Other cameras, though made of mostly plastic, had a build quality so good that we walked around with a certain mental satisfaction that if we did drop the camera, no harm would come to it (no, we didn't test this theory).

However, we wish we could say the same about the kit lenses these cameras came with. Now, the Fujifilm kit lens (18-55mm) is a solid tank, made with full metal construction. We had no worries there. But the lens on the Sony NEX-6 (the 16-50mm f/3.5-5.6 PZ lens) for example had us worried as it extends outwards



Fujifilm X-E1